that diplomatic marathon, however, than an agreement to stop engaging in "adverse propaganda."[3]

Ayub focused his own energy on introducing a constitution to Pakistan based on what he called "basic democracy." The vast majority of an electorate of sixty thousand "basic democrats," most of them young men from military families, and each representing a district of Pakistan, voted to express complete confidence in Ayub Khan when he held a single-question referendum on his worthiness to serve as president. Ayub and his enterprising son worked hard at creating a beautiful new capital for Pakistan, Islamabad, built mostly of white marble and stone on the virgin land of Punjab's Potwar Plateau, north of Rawalpindi. Before the end of 1964, crowded Karachi's old federal offices and embassies were abandoned and their occupants moved to Islamabad's handsome new buildings.

Early in 1965, Ayub received his first shipment of new U.S. M48 tanks, with their 90 mm guns. Foreign Minister Bhutto urged Ayub to promote himself to field marshal, since there were by then so many generals in Pakistan's army. Bhutto also proposed the liberation of Kashmir, explaining that Nehru's death in 1964 would make it easy for Pakistan to "take back" that state. Nehru's successor, tiny Lai Bahadur Shastri, Bhutto believed, was no match for the giant Ayub, who would initially test Shastri's resolve in the desolate salt marsh Rann of Kutch, the southern portion of West Pakistan's border with India, which remained dry till annual monsoon rains started to flood it in June.

That April, Pakistani patrols opened fire on several Indian border guards at Sardar in the Rann, triggering responding fire, soon after which a swift column of Patton tanks rumbled with ease through lightly defended Indian barricades. Ayub's new tanks performed so well, indeed, that he was eager to test them again, in Kashmir. Bhutto assured Ayub that he had firm intelligence indicating very strong support throughout the Vale of Kashmir for a Pakistani invasion. Early in August 1965, UN observers reported heavy artillery fire from Pakistan over the cease-fire line, followed by major infiltration. Bhutto boldly denied any Pakistani incitement, however, insisting to the press in mid-August that Kashmir was experiencing a "spontaneous uprising against Indian tyranny."

However, Prime Minister Shastri, speaking from the top of Delhi's Red Fort, charged Pakistan with having invaded Kashmir, and vowed to his nation that such aggression against India would never be allowed to succeed. Before the end of August, Indian and Pakistani regular units